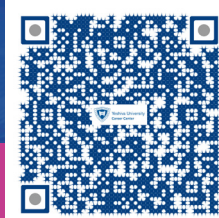


INDUSTRY OVERVIEW

FASHION AND RETAIL INDUSTRY



FOR ADDITIONAL
INFORMATION SCAN
THE CODE

WHAT IS FASHION AND RETAIL?

Regardless of whether you are interested in logistics, garment technology, merchandising, pattern design, fashion photography or fashion marketing and PR, there are numerous opportunities to join the fashion and retail industry. Career paths exist on the business side as well as the design or creative side, and each function requires a different set of skills and requirements. Overall, knowledge of the product and target customer is imperative to be successful in this field.

OUTLOOK

In the face of foreign competition, the future of the apparel industry is unclear. Employment in the domestic apparel industry has declined dramatically in recent years as foreign companies have become able to produce goods less expensively than the United States.

According to the U.S. Department of Labor (DOL), employment of Fashion designers is projected to show little or no change from 2020 to 2030.

Despite limited employment growth, about 2,500 openings for fashion designers are projected each year, on average, over the decade. Most of those openings are expected to result from the need to replace workers who transfer to different occupations or exit the labor force, such as to retire.

Firsthand Guide, bit.ly/39303Ea

SKILLS AND ABILITIES

Business-related skills:

- Bookkeeping/understands payroll and financial matters
- Inventory management and ordering
- Understands the concepts of generating revenue and making a profit

Design-related skills:

- Creativity/Ingenuity
- Strong sense of style
- Teamwork/Leadership
- Comfortable working in a stressful environment
- Able to delegate and prioritize
- Superior writing and descriptive skills
- Ability to translate ideas into words
- Respect and embrace diversity
- Tactful communication
- Social media
- Technologies
e.g. Computer Aided Design



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STRATEGY AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

CAREER TRACKS

Career options in Fashion and Retail include:

- Distribution Manager
- Fashion Consultant/Stylist
- Fashion Designer
- Fashion Illustrator
- Fashion Publishing
- Product Manager
- Production and Sourcing
- Public Relations Specialist
- Retail Merchant/Buyer
- Retail Planners
- Retail Store Manager
- Store Planner/Designer
- Supply Chain Specialist
- Quality Assurance Director

Entry level titles within this industry include:

- Assistant Designer
- Sales Assistant

KEY RESUME SEARCH TERMS (SEO)

Fashion

- Client support
- Design concepts
- Luxury fashion merchandising
- Sourced and qualified

Retail

- Budgetary/inventory controls
- Customer service focused/performance
- Employee relations
- Fast-paced
- High volume
- Maximize profitability
- Motivate
- Positive working environment
- Productivity
- Sales objectives/goals
- Self-motivated
- Store operations
- Supervise
- Train
- Visual merchandising

Using statements of accomplishment on your resume is the most effective way to demonstrate your skills and leverage resume buzzwords.

Rank higher in the system or in a recruiter's search results by matching your resume keywords to exactly what's in the job description.

SALARY EXPECTATIONS

Median pay for Fashion Designers: \$75,810 per year

Bureau of Labor Statistics, U.S. Department of Labor, Occupational Outlook Handbook, Fashion Designers, bit.ly/2PQiPXw

CAREER RESOURCES

- [Fashion Business Careers](#)
- [Fashion Portfolio Creation](#)
- [Free Fashion Internships](#)
- [Style Careers](#)
- [Vault](#)
- [VelvetJobs Fashion Jobs](#)

PROFESSIONAL NETWORKING ORGANIZATIONS

- [Cosmetics, Beauty, and Fashion Job Opportunities: LinkedIn](#)
- [Fashion and Lifestyle Industry Professionals Worldwide: LinkedIn](#)
- [Fashion Group International](#)
- [Retail Industry Leaders Association](#)